Phase2

U.S. NAVAL INSTITUTE | USNI.ORG

What's Changing on usni.org

October 2026

AGENDA

What We'll Cover Today

Why Change, and Why Now

What Stays the Same

What We're Adding

What We're Refining

This is an evolution, not a rebuild. usni.org keeps the shape your members know. We're adding new ways to explore more than 150 years of writing, and fixing the places where readers currently reach a dead end.

01

Why Change, and Why Now

An Exceptional Archive That's Hard to Explore

An archive few institutions can match

USNI has published nearly 35,000 magazine articles over 153 years, across Proceedings and Naval History.

But hard to explore today

Most of it can only be found if a reader already knows which issue an article appeared in. There's no simple way to ask, "What has USNI published on mine warfare?" and see the answer in one place.

Three Issues Holding the Site Back

No way to explore by subject

Content is organized by issue alone. Nothing brings related writing together across both magazines and across decades.

Dead ends in the archive

Many older articles have no issue or year page above them. A reader who clicks "up" from a 1912 article lands on an error page instead of more reading.

Tags that outgrew their purpose

Around 13,000 free-text tags have built up over the years, many duplicated or used only once. They no longer reliably connect readers to related work.

The Archive by the Numbers

153

Years of published writing on the site

1,300

Pages and more that a reader had to click through in the old archive listing

13K

Around 13,000 free-text tags in use today, with no shared structure

02

What Stays the Same

What Members Rely On Stays in Place

Unchanged by this work

- Issue pages stay exactly as they are; topic pages sit alongside issues, not in place of them
- Proceedings and Naval History keep their own sections and identities
- Article web addresses stay the same, so bookmarks and citations keep working
- The Press catalogue stays where it is
- Membership, Giving and About keep their structure, with light tidying only
- The main navigation stays familiar, with one new item: Browse

USNI News and the photo archive remain on their own sites. This work covers usni.org only.

Existing Links Keep Working

88%

Of magazine articles keep their exact web address (30,572 of 34,699)

99%

Of Press book pages keep their exact address (803 of 807); the other four redirect

100%

Of anything that moves gets a redirect, so bookmarks and citations still resolve

03

What We're Adding

A New Way In: Explore by Subject

How readers find content today

Start from an issue and work through it. Finding everything on a subject means already knowing where to look.

How they'll be able to find it

Start from a topic, ship, region, conflict, command or organization, and see everything USNI has published on it, across both magazines and every decade. Every article will also list its topics, linking readers straight to the matching subject pages.

A single new Browse page ties it all together. It is the only new item in the main navigation.

234 Subject Pages, Six Ways to Explore

74 topic pages: everything on a subject, from 1891 Proceedings to 2019 Naval History

64 ship and ship-class pages: a ship's full story across 153 years

30 region pages: for readers who think in theaters of operation

26 command and unit pages: serving readers often look for their own command first

20 organization pages: shipbuilders, agencies and allied navies

19 conflict and era pages: how historians and students search the archive

Topic pages are the headline change. For a naval audience, ship pages may become the most valued view on the site.

A Working Model of the New Browse

What it shows

How the archive is organized and found: the seven ways in (topic, ship, region, conflict, command, organization and contributor) and the filters that narrow results. It runs on 34,686 real Proceedings and Naval History articles, tagged with the proposed vocabulary.

What it is not

It is not the visual design. Layout and styling are borrowed from the current prototype, and images are placeholders. As you click through, focus on how content is grouped, labeled and filtered.

Open the Browse concept →

Closing the Dead Ends in the Archive

A page for every year

192 new year pages, one for each year of each magazine, listing that year's issues. They replace an archive listing that ran more than 1,300 pages deep.

Restoring 11 missing issues

Eleven issues have articles on the site but no issue page of their own, so readers who click up hit an error. Each missing issue page will be created.

One Article, Before and After

Today

A reader lands on a December 1912 Proceedings article and clicks up to see the rest of that issue. The issue page doesn't exist, and neither does a page for 1912, so the click ends on an error page.

After

The same click opens the December 1912 issue. One more step up shows every issue published in 1912. From there, subject pages let the reader follow the same topic forward through later decades.

The same fix applies to all 11 missing issues and to every year of both magazines.

A Proper Home for Books and Essay Contests

Front pages for 22 online books

Each book gains a front page and its part divisions, so readers can start at the beginning and search results have a clear page to point to.

A page for each contest, by year

Contests move from one long list to contest, then year, then essays. Endowed contests keep their own names, honoring the donors behind them.

04

What We're Refining

WHAT'S CHANGING

Targeted Changes That Make the Site Easier to Use

Everything that moves gets a redirect, so no existing link breaks

- Naval History moves to one web address, reuniting its archive
- All Issues replaces the "current issue" page as one stable starting point
- Each contributor gets one profile covering everything they've written
- Plans & Pricing gets its own page, instead of a link partway down Membership
- Photo Gallery joins the navigation, linking to the photo archive
- Browse Proceedings and Browse Naval History stay separate from All Issues: browsing a magazine and listing its issues are different tasks

Why We're Consolidating Tags

Today: around 13,000 free-text tags

- Added one at a time over many years, with duplicates and one-off tags throughout. Readers can't rely on them to surface related writing, and each one generates a thin listing page.

Proposed: a managed vocabulary

- 74 topics, plus dedicated lists for ships, regions, eras, commands, organizations and people. Departments such as Commentary and Now Hear This stay as they are.

No one retags anything by hand. Existing tags are mapped automatically.

What This Means for Your Editors

Day-to-day publishing stays familiar

- Existing articles don't need retagging; current tags are mapped to the new vocabulary automatically
- New articles are tagged by choosing from the managed lists, rather than typing free-text tags
- New topics can still be added, through a shared review step
- Publishing by issue continues just as it does today

The shared review keeps the vocabulary consistent as USNI's coverage grows.

Retiring Pages That No Longer Serve Readers

204 pages retire, and each one redirects to the page that replaces it

- Automatically generated tag and category listings, replaced by the new topic pages
- Numbered listing pages ("Page 47 of 1,361") with no content of their own, replaced by year pages
- Empty pages, and pages duplicated at two addresses



Easier to Find, in Search and in AI Answers

Stable pages to point to

All Issues, year pages and book front pages don't change from month to month, so search engines and AI tools can link to them with confidence.

One clear page per subject

Topic, ship and region pages give search engines and AI assistants a single page to cite when someone asks about a subject USNI has covered.

Less clutter around the best work

Retiring empty, duplicate and automatically generated pages means USNI's strongest writing no longer competes with its thinnest pages.



Our commitment: every page on today's site has been reviewed individually. Each one keeps its address, moves with a redirect, or retires with a redirect to its replacement. Nothing is silently dropped.

What We'd Like From You

Approve the plan

Confirm the approach outlined today: what we're adding, what we're refining and what stays the same.

Sign off on the topics

Review and approve the 74 topics and the supporting lists for ships, regions, eras, commands, organizations and people.

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Thank You